



IN BRIEF

BONDAGE TO FREEDOM

Up to 12 million African slaves were transported to the Americas from the 16th century onward. Many were women, who were later pivotal in the abolition of slavery.

BEFORE 1700

- **1619** The first African slaves, including at least one woman, land at the British colony of Jamestown in what is now Virginia, US.
- **1621** The Dutch West India Company is formed, a principal mover in the transatlantic slave trade.
- **1656** Elizabeth Key successfully sues for her freedom on the grounds that her father was an English settler; the Virginia House of Burgesses then rules that a child born to an enslaved mother is a slave, regardless of the status of the father.

1700

- **1716** A slave known only as Maria leads a slave rebellion in Curacao, in the Dutch West Indies.
- **1781** Philadelphian slave Elizabeth Freeman sues her owner for her freedom and wins.
- **1791** A slave insurrection in the French colony of St. Domingue sparks the Haitian Revolution; in 1802, freed woman Sanité Bélair is executed at the age of 21 for her part in the rebellion.

1800

- **1831** Nat Turner incites a slave revolt in Virginia; one woman is tried for her involvement.
- **1833** The Philadelphia Female Anti-Slavery Society is founded by 18 women, in response to the fact that the American Anti-Slavery Society only admits male members.
- **1843** A woman, Carlota, is one of three slaves to lead a rebellion in Cuba known as the Year of the Lash.
- **1863** During the US Civil War Harriet Tubman leads the Combahee River Raid, destroying confederate provisions and freeing 750 slaves.
- **1865** The 13th amendment abolishes slavery (except in the case of imprisonment) in the US.

◀ **WOMEN PICK COTTON UNDER THE EYE OF AN OVERSEER IN GEORGIA, US, c.1900**

